



GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

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PURPOSE OF POLICY

1. To provide easily accessible machinery for settlement of grievances of employees & to adopt measures as would ensure expeditious settlement of grievances leading to increased satisfaction on the job & resulting in improved productivity & efficiency of the organization.
2. To study & recommend preventive action to minimize grievances of employees

SCOPE

This Policy applies to:

- All employees (full-time, part-time, fixed-term)
- Contractual staff (to the extent applicable)
- Interns, trainees, and article trainees
- Candidates during recruitment and selection processes
- Directors of the company

This policy also extends to employees deployed at **client locations**, working remotely, or in hybrid arrangements.

I. POLICY

- 1.1. 'Grievance' for the purpose of this scheme would only mean a grievance relating to individual employee arising out of the implementation of the policies/rules or decision of the organization. It includes matters of individual nature like those relating to leave, increment, non-extension of benefits under rules, interpretation of Service Rules etc.
- 1.2. Matters falling in the following areas shall not be covered under the Employees Grievance Redressal procedure:
 - a. Annual Performance Appraisals/Confidential Reports
 - b. Promotions
 - c. General Issues pertaining to benefits
 - d. Disciplinary action taken under Conduct, Discipline & Appeal Rules of the company
 - e. Cases relating to vigilance & security
 - f. Matters relating to training, nominations to training program.

PROCEDURE FOR HANDLING GRIEVANCES:

Individual grievance of an employee shall be processed & dealt in the following manner:

1.1. Stage I

An aggrieved employee shall send his grievance immediately & in any case within a period of 15 days of its occurrence to his HOD in writing. The HOD will give a personal hearing & try to resolve the grievance at his level within 10 days of receiving the grievance & intimate his decision to the aggrieved employees in writing within a week. Decision of the HOD will be within the framework of the existing Rules/Policies of the Company. In case grievance is not settled within the stipulated time, an interim reply will be sent & in any case, final reply/decision will be given within 7 working days of sending the interim reply.

1.2. Stage II

If the aggrieved employee is not satisfied with the reply of Stage I authority, or has not got a reply within the stipulated time, he may submit his grievance in writing to the Unit HR Manager within 10 days of receipt/due date of receipt of reply from the Stage I authority. The Unit HR Manager shall go through the Grievance & settle the same at his level. Decision of the Unit HR Manager will be within the framework of the existing Rules/Policies of the company. If the aggrieved employee decides to present his case personally before the Unit HR Manager, the aggrieved employee shall be given an opportunity to do so before the Unit HR Manager takes a decision on the grievance. The decision taken shall be communicated in writing to the aggrieved employee within 10 working days of the receipt of the grievance. In case grievance is not settled within the stipulated time, an interim reply will be sent & in any case, the final reply/decision will be given within 10 working days of sending the interim reply.

1.3. Stage III

If the aggrieved employee is not satisfied with the reply of Stage II authority, or has not got a reply within the stipulated time, he may submit his grievance in writing to the grievance council within 10 days of receipt/due date of receipt of reply from the Unit HR Manager. At this stage, the grievance shall be addressed to the Secretary of the Grievance Council.

The Grievance Council shall go through the grievance in detail & give their recommendation within 10 days they receive the representation. If the aggrieved employee decides to present his case personally before the Grievance Council, the Grievance Council shall give him an opportunity to do so.

The decision of the grievance council shall be communicated in writing by the Secretary to the aggrieved employee as early as possible (within 10 days of the receipt of orders) & shall be final.

Nature of Grievances (Detailed list in Annexure):

- 1) Amenities/facilities
- 2) Jobs and Roles
- 3) Health & safety
- 4) Working environment
- 5) Victimisation and harassment
- 6) Benefits
- 7) Termination with/without notice period

Composition of the grievance council at Corporate and Unit:

The Grievance council shall be an apex council & shall be constituted at the Corporate Office and at the Unit and the composition of the committee can be as below. However, it will be discretion of the Unit Head to nominate members on the Committee.

At Corporate Office:

- a. Director
- b. Head - Human Resources
- c. Member- Finance Head

A member of HR Department nominated by the Head-HR shall function as the Secretary of the Grievance Council at the Unit.

- While considering a particular grievance, the Grievance Council may take the assistance of an Officer(s) having intimate/ specialized knowledge of the grievance in its deliberations from time to time.
- The Grievance Council shall meet at least once in a year or more frequently if need arises.
- While examining & finalizing individual grievance, the concerned authorities at different stages may also analyze the grievance & in suitable cases recommend adoption of appropriate policies in future to prevent recurrence of similar grievance.

General:

- The employees of the company shall avail this procedure for redressal of their grievances. The time limits prescribed for presenting for the grievances at every stage shall be followed strictly. However, the concerned authorities at different stages may condone the delay in putting up the grievance within the prescribed time limits, if they are satisfied that the delay is due to valid reasons & circumstances beyond the control of the aggrieved employee.
 - If the grievance arises out of an order given by the Management, the said order shall be complied with before the employee concerned invokes the procedure laid down for redressal of his grievance.
 - The Secretary, Grievance Council shall maintain necessary records concerning grievances at different stages. The number of grievances received, settled, & pending at the end of each month shall be reported to the Chairman of the Council at the Unit as well as the Member Secretary at the Corporate Office by 07th of the following month
 - In calculating the various time intervals in the above procedure, intervening weekly off & holidays, shall not be taken into consideration.
 - If the grievance of the employee relates to a member of the Grievance Committee, such member will cease to be a member of the committee for that particular grievance.
 - If the grievance of the employee is against an officer dealing with the grievance at the first stage, the employee can directly refer his case to the II stage.
 - If the grievance of the employee is against the HOD/Unit HR to which the employee belongs, he can directly go to the 3rd stage i.e., the Grievance council.
 - If the grievance is against the Unit Head, the grievance should be addressed to the Corporate Grievance council.
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Authority for Exceptions and Others:

- The Director, may at his discretion, relax the rules in exceptional cases for reasons to be recorded.
- This policy & Rules shall come into force with immediate effect & shall remain in force as may be decided by the Management.
- The Management reserves the right to withdraw, review, alter and/or amend this Policy & Rules as may be deemed necessary from time to time.

This Policy & Rules shall supersede the earlier policy, rules, regulations, orders & instructions issued on the subject, except to the extent expressly provided in this Policy & Rules

II. ANNEXURE : NATURE OF GRIEVANCES

➤ Amenities/Facilities; shall include on the following subjects:

- 1) Noise/Sound Pollution
- 2) Temperature/Humidity
- 3) Illumination / Lighting
- 4) Housekeeping
- 5) Sitting Facilities
- 6) Drinking Water
- 7) Sanitation & Cleanliness
- 8) Rest Rooms

➤ Job and Roles; shall include on the following subjects:

- 1) Role Ambiguity
- 2) Job Dissatisfaction
- 3) Job Rotation
- 4) Role Conflict
- 5) Career Development
- 6) Termination with/without notice period

➤ Health and Safety; shall include on the following subjects:

- 1) Health Check
 - 2) Medical Insurance
 - 3) First Aid Appliances
 - 4) Safety appliances like fire safety
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- Working Environment; shall include on the following subjects:
 - 1) Employee participation
 - 2) Stress and work pressure
 - 3) Relationship at work – Disputes amongst peers
 - 4) Disputes amongst employee's & superior's
 - 5) Interpersonal Relations
 - 6) Aggressive behavior
 - 7) Discrimination on caste/creed/language
 - Victimization and Harassment; shall include the following subjects:
 - 1) Personally offensive verbal comments
 - 2) Crude and unwelcome telephone calls, notes, drawings, faxes or e-mails
 - 3) Derogatory comments about a person's body, appearance or personal life
 - 4) Sexist or racist jokes or jokes which make fun of a person's origin or disability
 - 5) Spreading of rumors
 - 6) A pattern of deliberately ignoring or excluding a person
 - 7) Offensive material that is displayed in a public place
 - 8) Sexual Harassment at work place
 - Benefits shall include on the following subjects:
 - 1) Reimbursements & Allowance
 - 2) Leave travel assistance
 - 3) Tax calculation
 - 4) Leave
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